

**Board 1**  
 South Deals  
 None Vul

♠ Q 8 2  
 ♥ J 6 4  
 ♦ J 7 5  
 ♣ 9 8 7 3

♠ 7 5 4  
 ♥ K 9 7  
 ♦ K 8 6 2  
 ♣ A Q 5



♠ A K J  
 ♥ A Q 3  
 ♦ A 4 3  
 ♣ K 10 4 2

♠ 10 9 6 3  
 ♥ 10 8 5 2  
 ♦ Q 10 9  
 ♣ J 6

| West                          | North | East | South |
|-------------------------------|-------|------|-------|
|                               |       |      | 2NT   |
| Pass                          | 4NT   | Pass | 6NT   |
| All Pass                      |       |      |       |
| 6NT by South<br>a 40% chance. |       |      |       |

Partner's 4NT bid is not Blackwood, it is the Quantitative 4NT. He is unsure whether to bid 6NT or not, so is inviting you to do so.

With 20 points you are supposed to pass. With 21 points you are supposed to bid 6NT. The evaluations probably aren't that accurate, but at least you have an excuse to bid 6NT.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♣9. East plays the ♣J which you take with your ♣K.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 11

There are two places you might find your twelfth winner. You can finesse East for the ♠Q; this is a 50% chance. Or, the ♦s might split 3-3; this is about

If you try the ♠ finesse and it fails you will go down even if the ♦s are splitting 3-3.

If you play ♦A, ♦K then another ♦, a 4-2 ♦ split will defeat you even if the ♠Q was with East.

Two chances are always better than one. The way to take both chances is to duck a ♦ at trick 2. Win whatever the defenders play next and then test the ♦s. If they do split your last ♦ will be trick #12. But if they don't split you can still try the ♠ finesse.

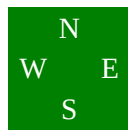
Ducking the ♦ was the correct play - not just because it worked, but because it gave you the opportunity to try an alternate method if it didn't work.

**Board 2**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ J 7 3  
♥ K J 9  
♦ Q J 10 4  
♣ 8 5 2

♠ A 9  
♥ Q 10 6 3  
♦ 8 5 2  
♣ Q J 9 4



♠ Q 10 5 4  
♥ A 8 4 2  
♦ 9 6 3  
♣ 10 7

♠ K 8 6 2  
♥ 7 5  
♦ A K 7  
♣ A K 6 3

| West                         | North | East | South |
|------------------------------|-------|------|-------|
|                              |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass                         | 2♣    | Pass | 2♠    |
| Pass                         | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass                     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South                 |       |      |       |
| ♦s with East following suit. |       |      |       |

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 8

Don't worry any more about the ♦s since there is nothing more you can do. Instead, worry about where that one more winner is going to come from. The answer will have to be: *from the ♥ suit*.

You might be tempted to take your 4 ♣ tricks right away, but avoid the temptation. The ♣ suit is your convenient transportation back and forth between hands.

You will have to lose at least 2 ♥ tricks in order to set up 1 winner, and by the time you do that the defenders will have established at least 1 more ♦ trick. What that means is that you cannot afford 3 ♥ losers. So how will you play the ♥s?

You should play West for the ♥J plus one of the big ones. This is a better chance than playing him for both the ♥ A K. So play a ♥ toward dummy and insert the ♥10 when West plays low. East wins with the ♥A and clears the ♦s. Play another ♥ toward dummy's ♥Q. West can take his ♥K and cash his ♦ winner but dummy's ♥Q will be your ninth trick.

There were two ♥ distributions which would allow you to make this contract.

West could hold both the ♥A and ♥K, in which case leading toward dummy's ♥Q would be the winning play.

West could hold **EITHER** ♥ A J x **OR** ♥ K J x in which case finessing dummy's ♥J would be the winning play. This is the more likely distribution of the two.

With 9 points you have just enough to respond. And with a 4-card Major suit you should use Stayman so you bid 2♣. Partner duly replies 2♠.

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You don't have a 4-4 ♥ fit, so you invite the notrump game by bidding 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT and West leads the ♦Q. Should you win or hold up?

A pretty good argument against holding up could be that they might switch to ♠s. However, say you do in fact hold up and that West does in fact continue

**Board 3**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 4 2

♥ 8 3

♦ 9 7 4

♣ J 10 7 4 3

♠ 8 7 3

♥ A 6

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ A Q 6 2



♠ A 9 5

♥ Q 10 2

♦ K Q 10 6 3

♣ K 8

♠ K Q J 10

♥ K J 9 7 5 4

♦ A

♣ 9 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

but you would then establish ♦s and make an overtrick!

But who said East would play another ♥ after winning the ♥K? What if he wins the ♥K and switches to ♠s? They might then win 3 ♠ tricks to go with their ♥K and ♦A.

Instead you should grab the first trick with dummy's ♥A and start playing ♦s. East will take the ♦A but you still have the ♠A and ♥Q as stoppers.

Just look at East's hand. If you duck the ♥A it will be crystal clear to him that he can defeat the contract by winning the ♥K and then switching to the ♠K.

Don't give him the chance.

You should not make a takeout double with three cards in their suit. A 2♦ overcall would be a reasonable choice. But with 15 points, balanced, and a stopper in ♥s a 1NT overcall is probably better.

Partner bids 3NT.

South plays 3NT. As expected, West leads his partner's ♥ suit.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1/2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 5/6

You need at least 4 ♦ winners.

If you play low from dummy on the ♥ lead East can win the ♥K but this will give you an extra ♥ stopper. He could drive out dummy's ♥A at trick 2,

**Board 4**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 2  
♥ K 8 3  
♦ 10 8 5 4  
♣ Q 10 6 2

♠ K 6 3

♥ A 10 5

♦ A 7 6 2

♣ A 7 5



♠ A Q J 9 7 4

♥ -

♦ K Q J 3

♣ J 8 3

♠ 8 5

♥ Q J 9 7 6 4 2

♦ 9

♣ K 9 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♠

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

help you, so it is more logical to play West for the ♥K. But if West does have the ♥K it will do you no good to ruff East's ♠A, West will over-ruff and you would still have that ♣ loser.

So do it this way instead. Discard the ♣ loser on East's ♠A! Another ♠ from East won't hurt you since dummy would be able to over-ruff West. Whatever East plays you can win, then finesse West out of his ♥K.

It was said earlier that you didn't have a winner on which you could discard the ♣ loser.

That was true, so instead you were able to discard it on a loser!

You would really like to have a transfer bid in this situation, to make North bid ♥s.

But you don't have one, so you just bid 4♥ yourself.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠10. You play low in dummy and West holds the trick. He continues the suit and East takes the ♠Q and then plays the ♠A.

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

You've already lost the 2 ♠s. If West has the ♥K you might avoid a loser there. You don't have a winner on which to discard the ♣ loser.

If East has the ♥K it will have to be a singleton to help you, so it is more logical to play West for the ♥K. But if West does have the ♥K it will do you no good to ruff East's ♠A, West will over-ruff and you would still have that ♣ loser.